

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS



INDIA-CHINA RELATIONS - 2

MODULE - 13

ii

SOUTH CHINA SEA

The Indian and Chinese civilisations are both ancient civilisations but different in their approach.

1

India's civilisation can be understood as 'Vasudaiva Kutumbakum', which means the world is one family.

2

The Chinese way of thinking is referred to as Chung Wo, which means middle kingdom or middle country, and their approach is that they are the centre of the world and everything else revolves around them.

3

This explains its expansionist policies and its territorial and maritime claims.

4

One such example is the South China Sea. South China Sea is a strategic maritime link between Pacific and Indian Ocean and is a vital gateway for shipping in East Asia. It is rich in oil and other natural resources



CHINA IN SOUTH CHINA SEA

- 1 China asserts sovereignty over the South China Sea in the 'historical context' and claims almost the entire Sea as its sovereign territory
- 2 It has been building military bases on artificial islands in the region.
- 3 The region is also claimed by Brunei, Malaysia, the Philippines, Taiwan and Vietnam.
- 4 China has affected commercial activities like fishing or mineral exploration by countries like Vietnam and the Philippines.



CHINA IN SOUTH CHINA SEA

5 The Chinese military has set up radars, deployed missiles and missile launchers and warplanes on islands and reefs in the region.

6 China has constructed several artificial islands in the Sea including the Mischief reef, which has a harbor and airfield.

7 In 2019, China deployed an operational airship known as an aerostat in the disputed Mischief Reef strengthening its reconnaissance ability in the South China Sea and monitoring activities

8 These activities give the US and other Southeast Asian nations that China is building a 'Maritime Empire'



INDIA'S INTERESTS IN SOUTH CHINA SEA

- 1 India wants to keep the sea lanes open in the South China Sea as half of its sea trade passes through it.
- 2 India has been expanding its naval reach from the Arabian Sea to the South China Sea through various naval exercises
- 3 In 2004, it tried to project its blue-water capability by deploying five of its front-line warships in the South China Sea
- 4 As a display of its capabilities and outreach, especially with Japan and Vietnam, India is deepening ties with the littoral states of South China Sea



INDIA'S INTERESTS IN SOUTH CHINA SEA

- 5 Southeast Asian countries encourage joint maritime exercises with India.
- 6 India has a strong navy and technological capabilities that can be leveraged by the ASEAN countries.
- 7 At Vietnam's request, India opposes oil exploration of China in the sea.
- 8 But Beijing warns India to stay away from the South China sea as it affects its 'sovereignty'.



- 1 Pakistan is strategically important to China. China's closeness with Pakistan creates an atmosphere of distrust and suspicion in the Indo-China relations.
- 2 Since the 1970s, China has provided nuclear and missile-related assistance to Pakistan.
- 3 China is providing economic assistance and political backing to Pakistan. These investments can be used as diplomatic leverage
- 4 Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi describes Sino-Pak relations as an 'all-weather friendship'.
- 5 China has blocked India's appeal to list Jaish-e-Mohammad (JeM) chief Masood Azhar as a "global terrorist" at the United Nations Security Council (UNSC). India objects these postures of China

iii

PAKISTAN FACTOR

6 As part of the CPEC, in Pakistan, China plans to invest \$46 billion dollars in economic corridor between China's western region and Pakistan's Gwadar sea port which will shorten China's route to middle east countries for their oil imports by about 12000 km.

7 CPEC also involves constructing power plants, roads and railways

8 China-Pak cooperation in the Gwadar port and other regions affect India's interests in Indian Ocean and Arabian Sea

9 Military cooperation between China and Pakistan threatens India's interests



iii

PAKISTAN FACTOR

10 In 2020, the two countries completed a nine day naval exercise called Operation Sea Guardians, live fire exercises which included special forces, warships, aerial assets and submarines

11 China has assisted Pakistan in the development of Shaheen II medium range ballistic missile

12 China also has free trade agreement with Pakistan which makes China 3rd largest trade partner of Pakistan

13 It helps China gain access and enhance trade with Middle East nations



iv

MEMBERSHIP OF INTERNATIONAL ORGANISATIONS

UNSC

1 China opposes India's entry as a permanent member of United Nations Security Council (UNSC) on the ground that reform of the UNSC concerns the long-term development of the UN and interests of all members must be met in the process.

2 China-Pakistan strategic partnership also acts as a hindrance to India's entry

NSG

It also opposes India's entry into the Nuclear Suppliers Group (NSG) on the ground that India has not signed the Nuclear Non Proliferation Treaty (NPT).



BORDER ISSUES

i

DOKLAM STANDOFF

1 Doklam is a region in the tri-junction of India, Bhutan and China. India and Bhutan recognize it as Doklam and a part of the Bhutanese territory.

2 China, however, claims it to be a part of the Donglang region

3 On 16 June 2017, Chinese troops made an incursion into the disputed territory of Doklam.

4 They had road-building equipment with them and aimed at extending a road into the disputed territory.



BORDER ISSUES

i

DOKLAM STANDOFF

INDIA'S RESPONSE

1 By virtue of the Friendship Treaty signed between India and Bhutan in 2007, India is committed to protecting Bhutan's interests. Thus India entered the region on Bhutan's requests (according to several reports).

2 On 18 June, around 270 Indian soldiers, with weapons and 2 bulldozers, entered Doklam to stop the Chinese troops from constructing the road.

3 Later, on 29th June, Bhutan protested the Chinese excursion.

4 Eventually, both India and China withdrew their troops from Doklam on 28th August 2017 after more than two months of faceoff and the road construction has halted.



BHUTAN FACTOR

- 1** In 2020, at the Global Environment Facility (GEF), China claimed the Sakteng Wildlife Sanctuary, located in eastern Bhutan.
- 2** Bhutan, however disputed the claim. Bhutan's far-eastern areas, where the Sakteng sanctuary is located, is claimed by China as a part of "South Tibet" and part of its territory.
- 3** This claim is a part of China's 'Western Development Strategy' that aims to facilitate Tibet to regain a central position in the Himalayan system.
- 4** According to scholars, the Sino-Bhutan border dispute is not a contest for territory but a repercussion of Bhutan's friendship with India.
- 5** The China is targeting the western areas to enlarge the narrow Chumbi Valley and gain access to the Siliguri Corridor through Doklam



BORDER ISSUES

ii

GALWAN VALLEY

- 1 Indian and Chinese armies have been in a standoff in eastern Ladakh including Pangong Tso, Galwan Valley and Gogra Hot Spring since May 5, 2020.
- 2 In an attempt to push India to settle the boundary issue and cede Aksai Chin to China, Chinese began intrusions into the Indian side of LAC.
- 3 On June 15, 2020, violent clashes took place between the armies in the Galwan Valley killing 20 Indian Army personnel.
- 4 According to experts, it is to address internal security concerns of China.



BORDER ISSUES

ii

GALWAN VALLEY

5 China has acted similarly in the past as well when it wanted to settle the border with Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan and Tajikistan.

6 In order to avert the security threats in the sensitive Xinjiang region after the disintegration of Soviet collapse, China occupied territories from Kazakhstan and had Kazakhstan denounce Uyghur separatism and curb anti-China activities. Kyrgyzstan and Tajikistan were also made to surrender territories



BORDER ISSUES

ii

GALWAN VALLEY

7 Through the Ladakh incursion, the Chinese are possibly trying to convey three essential points.

1. Settle the boundary dispute on its terms.
2. Solve the Tibet problem internally without Indian interference.
3. Discourage a US-led QUAD strategic forum.

8 India probably prefers having a marginal modification in the current alignment of the boundary to settle the issue but cannot agree on giving Tawang as China demands.

9 Ceding Aksai Chin would fundamentally alter the status of J&K and Ladakh and India would have to forgo PoK and Gilgit-Baltistan



RESOLUTION OF STANDOFF

- 1 National Security Advisor Ajit Doval and Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi ultimately intervened and held discussions to resolve the issue.
- 2 It resulted into withdrawal of the Chinese military from the Galwan Valley and Gogra Hot Spring.
- 3 On July 5, they agreed that it was necessary to ensure at the earliest complete disengagement of the troops along the LAC and de-escalation from India-China border areas for full restoration of peace and tranquillity.



ECONOMIC

CHINA'S MODEL OF DEVELOPMENT

The economic reason for Beijing's expansionism lies in its model of development.

- 1 The Chinese growth model is based on the availability of emerging markets to continue its investments and achieve high growth rates.
- 2 The One Belt One Road initiative was introduced as a meeting point for China's geo-strategic and geo-economic interests.
- 3 Hence to achieve this, China has expanded its global footprint in over 100 countries including acting aggressively in Southeast Asian countries and its recent actions in Hong Kong.



ECONOMIC

INDO-CHINA TRADE

1

India faces the following trade issues with China:

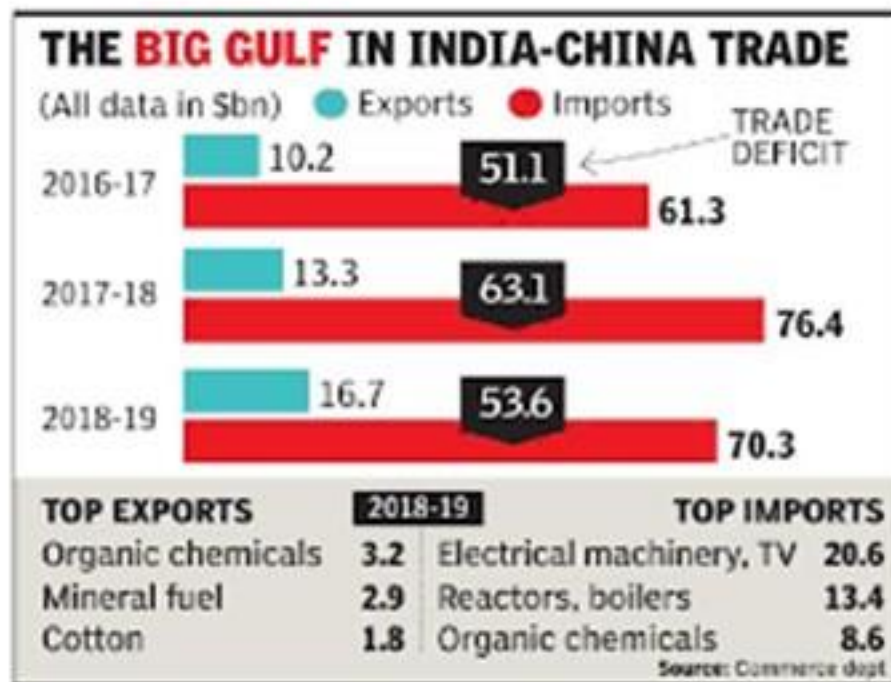
- significant trade imbalance in favour of China
- market access issues and protectionist policies especially in Indian IT, pharmaceuticals and agro-products.
- security considerations limiting bilateral trade.
- unable to compete with Chinese manufactured goods.



ECONOMIC

INDO-CHINA TRADE

- 2 India imports goods in critical and strategically sensitive sectors including semiconductors, pharmaceutical ingredients and 4G and 5G technology
- 3 In 2019-20, India has reduced its imports resulting in a reduced trade deficit of \$48.66 billion. This is lower than the previous financial year 2018-19 of \$53.56 billion.
- 4 India has made stricter norms for FDI from neighbors. It led to reduction in China's Foreign Direct Investment to India from \$229 million in 2018-19 to \$163.78 million in 2019-20



CYBER SECURITY

- 1 Since June 15, there has been an increase in coordinated cyber attacks by Chinese hackers in the nature of DDOS (distributed denial of service), phishing, data exfiltration, remote access tool malware and keylogging (tracking every keystroke made by a user).
- 2 In response, India banned 59 China made apps for reasons of national security and data privacy, in July 2020.
- 3 The Department of Telecommunications (DoT) asked web portals and websites to be vigilant and conduct a security audit.
- 4 The Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (Cert-In) has been asked to assess possible cyber-attacks in sensitive government websites and portals.
- 5 Reports suggest Chinese hackers were trying to collect data from websites and web portals of the Defence Ministry



WATER DISPUTES

Water-related conflict is a global and regional problem.

- 1** India and China share four major rivers
 1. The **Indus/Shiquan** River is shared by China, India, and Pakistan.
 2. The **Brahmaputra** River is shared by India, China, Bangladesh, and Bhutan.
 3. The **Kosi and Ghaghara** rivers are shared by China, Nepal, and India.

- 2** China happens to be the **upper riparian state**. India is the middle riparian state in the Brahmaputra, Indus, and Sutlej rivers, but a lower riparian state in the other two river systems

- 3** The possibility of water wars is based on the fact that China one of the **most water stressed countries in the world** and water scarcity is likely to increase because of industrialization, urbanization and pollution



AREAS OF CONTENTION

WATER DISPUTES

BRAHMAPUTRA RIVER BASIN

Among the shared rivers, most tensions exist along the Brahmaputra River due to three major reasons.

- 1 China occupies significant parts (50%) of the Brahmaputra River basin (highest when compared to other rivers). As a result, the potential impact of China's activities on the Brahmaputra River is much bigger as compared to other rivers.
- 2 For India, the river provides nearly 30% of the freshwater resources and about 40% of total hydropower potential.
- 3 Brahmaputra River is linked to Sino-Indian border disputes. The two countries have contested claims in the Eastern Himalayas



INDIA'S SUSPICIONS

China's perception of an uncooperative water hegemon is based on following points-

- 1 China is unwilling to sign any binding agreement with downstream countries over transboundary rivers.
- 2 Its passive role in international water governance. It was one of three countries to vote against the adoption by the UN General Assembly of the 1997 UN Convention on the Law of the Non-Navigational Uses of International Watercourses (UNWC), which seeks to strike a balance between upstream and downstream interests

WATER DISPUTES

- 3 China's strong interest in building dams on transboundary rivers in Tibet is a concern, including the upstream of Brahmaputra River.

DOWNSTREAM WOES

India is worried that a 510MW Chinese hydroelectric dam on the Brahmaputra – that became operational on 13th October – may reduce water flow for dam projects in Arunachal Pradesh.



CHINA'S RESPONSE

WATER DISPUTES

- 1 The Chinese government has assured India that it has **no plan to divert the Brahmaputra River** and its dam building plans will take into consideration the concerns of downstream countries.
- 2 Economic considerations are also important. Many experts argued that the **total construction cost will be too high** and it does not make economic sense to use the diverted water as it will be too expensive for the consumers.
- 3 **Social and environmental costs** constitute another important factor.



WATER DISPUTES

INDIA'S ACTIONS

- 1 In recent years, India has built power utilities in Arunachal Pradesh, a part of its efforts to make the region India's 'Power Plant.'
- 2 In October 2014, India approved building the 3000-MW Dibang multipurpose dam project. Dibang River is a tributary of the Brahmaputra River, in the disputed Arunachal Pradesh (South Tibet in China).
- 3 China considers India's dam building plans a threat to the country's water rights and a deliberate attempt to strengthen actual occupation of the disputed Arunachal Pradesh.

Without an effective working mechanism between the two countries and with lingering border disputes, water conflicts could potentially become a serious challenge to Sino-Indian relations.



WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

For Information:

info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0866 244 44 72

98499 42299

94415 27588